

MSMEs SHAPING INDIA'S FUTURE. TOGETHER

"The future depends on what we do in the present" -Mahatma Gandhi

'Where will India be in two decades?' A common question discussed and debated in many forums. In almost all situations, the answer involves making comparisons to other countries, based on income, growth, physical and social infrastructure, nature of governance and government. These comparisons are based on the fundamental premise that there is a broadly predestined path to growth and transformation. However, the central question regarding India's future should move from 'What is India's potential?' to 'How can India's true potential be unlocked?' The answer to this may draw certain inspirations from other countries' journeys, current global context and collective actions to realise self reliant India.

INDIA IS AT A TURNING POINT

With the Hon'ble Prime Minister's clarion call for "Atmanirbhar Bharat", the correlation between the Indian economy and the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) performance has never been more aligned. MSMEs are the growth drivers and play a critical role in the equitable socio-economic development of the nation. The contributions of the sector are essential for fulfilling the vision of Aatmanirbhar Bharat, i.e. creating an economically self-reliant nation. the sector also presents an opportunity to drive inclusive social growth for upliftment of economically underserved communities. Furthermore, MSMEs help nurture the entrepreneurial spirit of the nation, thereby achieving its vision of being a self-reliant economy in the near future. Currently, it consists of over 6 crore units employing over 11 crore people contributing over 30% to GDP and over 49% of overall exports from India.

Central Government focusing on providing a level-playing field for SC-ST entrepreneurs National Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes Hub (NSSH)

The Government of India envisions entrepreneurship as an integral part of accomplishing rapid and robust economic growth. To ensure inclusive growth across all sections of the society, especially the marginalized groups including SC/ST entrepreneurs, government is trying to make procurement activities of the public sector to more inclusive and participative.

To realize growth perspective for all, the Government of India has established Public Procurement Policy which mandates that 25% of total procurement of goods and services by Central Ministries and CPSEs shall be made from MSEs. Out of which 4% shall be made from MSEs owned by SC/ST entrepreneurs. Public Procurement Policy rests upon core principles of competitiveness, adhering to sound procurement practices and execution of orders for supply of goods or services in accordance with a system which is fair, equitable, transparent, competitive and cost effective.

To expedite achievement of the target, the government has initiated the launch of National SC-ST Hub (NSSH) with an aim not only to increase market access and ensure higher participation of SC/ST entrepreneurs in public procurement but also promote creation of new enterprises which is being implemented through the National Small Industries Corporation Limited (NSIC). The Hub was inaugurated on